



Cambridge International Examinations
Cambridge International General Certificate of Secondary Education

FIRST LANGUAGE ENGLISH

0500/31

Paper 3 Directed Writing and Composition

October/November 2016

MARK SCHEME

Maximum Mark: 50

Published

This mark scheme is published as an aid to teachers and candidates, to indicate the requirements of the examination. It shows the basis on which Examiners were instructed to award marks. It does not indicate the details of the discussions that took place at an Examiners' meeting before marking began, which would have considered the acceptability of alternative answers.

Mark schemes should be read in conjunction with the question paper and the Principal Examiner Report for Teachers.

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This document consists of **8** printed pages.

Page 2	Mark Scheme	Syllabus	Paper
	Cambridge IGCSE – October/November 2016	0500	31

Note: All Examiners are instructed that alternative correct answers and unexpected approaches in candidates' scripts must be given marks that fairly reflect the relevant knowledge and skills demonstrated. Nonetheless, the content must be clearly related to and derived from the passage.

Section 1: Directed Writing

Question 1

This question tests writing assessment objectives W1 to W5 (15 marks)

W1 articulate experience and express what is thought, felt and imagined

W2 sequence facts, ideas and opinions

W3 use a range of appropriate vocabulary

W4 use a register appropriate to audience and context

W5 make accurate use of spelling, punctuation and grammar

and reading assessment objectives R1 to R3 (10 marks)

R1 demonstrate understanding of explicit meanings

R2 demonstrate understanding of implicit meanings and attitudes

R3 analyse, evaluate and develop facts, ideas and opinions

Imagine that your friend, Louis, is considering setting up a Share-Shack in your community, and has asked for your views on whether this would be a good idea.

Write a letter to your friend.

In your letter you should:

- **evaluate the benefits of a Share-Shack to your community**
- **explain what risks you think might be involved.**

Base your letter on what you have read in the article, but be careful to use your own words. Address both of the bullet points.

**Begin your letter, 'Dear Louis,
I've heard about Share Shacks ...'**

Write about 250 to 350 words.

Up to 10 marks are available for the content of your answer, and up to 15 marks for the quality of your writing

[25]

Page 3	Mark Scheme	Syllabus	Paper
	Cambridge IGCSE – October/November 2016	0500	31

Responses might use the following ideas:

A1 potential benefits to your community

- **Provides a useful service** – access to a wide range of equipment/goods
- **Inclusive** – accessible to all, easy to join, limited cost
- **Sense of community**, socially responsible / positive behaviour / offers help
- **Saves money** – not worth / wasteful buying items you won't use often
- **Social space** – place to meet / get to know people, avoid isolation
- **Information point** – adverts for other services / ideas there too
- **Environmentally** sound, good use of resources

A2 what risks you think might be involved

- **Quality of items** available for borrowing – if cluttering up / unused, is it really just rubbish, will people donate anything useful?
- Some equipment may be dangerous to use if **user is unskilled**
- Some equipment may be **badly maintained** / unsafe
- **Relies on trust** – who will check / vet the adverts on the board? Meeting somewhere at the Share Shack doesn't mean it is safe to trust them
- **People taking advantage** – illegal / irresponsible activities e.g. storage space
- **Costs** might be prohibitive – Val relies on charity / volunteers
- **Need local support** – Val inspires / drives project – can Louis / is the area right
- **Insurance** if things go wrong / items are damaged or lost
- **Competition** – Trisi's plan is to expand – how many Share-Shacks will there be competing for Louis' business?

The discriminator is the development and evaluation of the arguments, which requires candidates to draw inferences and make judgements about whether the advantages outweigh the disadvantages in this particular case. Perceptive responses may consider the motivations of those involved in the scheme and this could affect the decision. Ideas and opinions must be derived from the passage, developing its claims and assessing their implications with clear and persuasive arguments.

Page 4	Mark Scheme	Syllabus	Paper
	Cambridge IGCSE – October/November 2016	0500	31

Marking criteria for Section 1, Question 1.

Table A, Writing:

Use the following table to give a mark out of 15 for Writing.

Band 1	13–15	Consistent sense of audience; authoritative and appropriate style. Fluent, varied sentences; wide range of vocabulary. Strong sense of structure, paragraphing and sequence. Spelling, punctuation and grammar almost always accurate.
Band 2	10–12	Sense of audience mostly secure; there is evidence of style and fluency; sentences and vocabulary are effective. Secure overall structure; mostly well-sequenced. Spelling, punctuation and grammar generally accurate.
Band 3	7–9	Occasional sense of audience; mostly written in correctly structured sentences; vocabulary may be plain but adequate for the task; mostly quite well structured. Minor, but more frequent, errors of spelling, punctuation and grammar.
Band 4	5–6	Inconsistent style; simple or faultily constructed sentences; vocabulary simple; basic structure. Frequent errors of spelling, punctuation and grammar.
Band 5	3–4	Inappropriate expression; the response is not always well sequenced. Errors of spelling, punctuation and grammar impair communication.
Band 6	1–2	Expression unclear; flawed sentence construction and order. Persistent errors of spelling, punctuation and grammar impede communication.
Band 7	0	The response cannot be understood.

Table B, Reading:

Use the following table to give a mark out of 10 for Reading.

Band 1	9–10	Gives a thorough, perceptive, convincing response. Reads effectively between the lines. Shows understanding by developing much of the reading material and assimilating it into a response to the task.
Band 2	7–8	Some evidence of evaluation, engaging with a few of the main points with success. Uses reading material to support the argument. Occasionally effective development of ideas from the passages.
Band 3	5–6	Reproduces a number of points to make a satisfactory response. The response covers the material adequately, but may miss opportunities to develop it relevantly or at length.
Band 4	3–4	Selects points from the passages rather literally and/or uses the material thinly. Points should be connected.
Band 5	1–2	Parts of the response are relevant, though the material may be repeated or used inappropriately.
Band 6	0	There is very little or no relevance to the question or to the passages, or the response copies unselectively or directly from the passages.

Page 5	Mark Scheme	Syllabus	Paper
	Cambridge IGCSE – October/November 2016	0500	31

Section 2: Composition

Questions 2, 3, 4 and 5

This question tests writing assessment objectives W1 to W5 (25 marks)

W1 articulate experience and express what is thought, felt and imagined

W2 sequence facts, ideas and opinions

W3 use a range of appropriate vocabulary

W4 use a register appropriate to audience and context

W5 make accurate use of spelling, punctuation and grammar

Write about 300 to 450 words on one of the following questions.

Up to 13 marks are available for the content and structure of your answer, and up to 12 marks for the style and accuracy of your writing.

Descriptive Writing

2 Describe an occasion when a group of people are eating together.

OR

3 Describe what you notice, think and feel as you sit in a busy workplace observing others go about their daily activities.

Narrative Writing

4 Write a story that includes the words, ‘Nothing could have prepared him for what he saw...’

OR

5 Write a story that involves a character new to the area.

Marking criteria for Section 2, Questions 2, 3, 4, 5

Use table A to give a mark out of 13 for content and structure, and table B to give a mark out of 12 for style and accuracy.

Page 6	Mark Scheme	Syllabus	Paper
	Cambridge IGCSE – October/November 2016	0500	31

Table A, Composition: Content and structure

		General criteria	Specific criteria	
			Descriptive Writing	Narrative Writing
Band 1	11–13	W1: Content is complex, sophisticated and realistic. W2: Overall structure is secure and the constituent parts well balanced and carefully managed.	Many well-defined and developed ideas and images create a convincing, original, overall picture with varieties of focus.	The plot is convincing with elements of fiction such as description, characterisation and climax, and with cogent detail.
Band 2	9–10	W1: Content develops some interesting and realistic features in parts of the writing. W2: Writing is orderly, and beginnings and endings are satisfactorily managed.	Frequent, well-chosen images and details give an impression of reality, although the overall picture is not consistent.	The plot incorporates some interesting features, but not consistently so: the reader may be aware of the creation of suspense and a sense of climax.
Band 3	7–8	W1: Content is straightforward with ideas, features and images that satisfactorily address the task; some opportunities for development are taken. W2: Overall structure is competent and some sentences are well sequenced.	A selection of relevant ideas, images and details addresses the task, even where there is a tendency to write a narrative.	The plot is straightforward and cohesive with some identification of features such as character and setting.
Band 4	5–6	W1: Content consists of relevant ideas that are briefly developed. W2: Overall structure is easily followed, though some constituent parts are too long or too short to be effective.	The task is addressed with a series of ordinary details, which may be more typical of a narrative.	Recording of relevant but sometimes unrealistic events outweighs other desirable elements of narrative fiction.

Page 7	Mark Scheme	Syllabus	Paper
	Cambridge IGCSE – October/November 2016	0500	31

		General criteria	Specific criteria	
			Descriptive Writing	Narrative Writing
Band 5	3–4	W1: Content is simple, and the presentation of ideas and events may only be partially credible. W2: Overall structure is recognizable though paragraphing is inconsistent and sequences of sentences insecure.	Where a narrative is written, the recording of events may preclude the use of sufficient descriptive detail.	The plot is a simple narrative that may consist of events that are only partially credible or which are presented with partial clarity.
Band 6	1–2	W1: Content is inconsistent in relevance, interest and clarity. W2: Structure is frequently unclear, revealing a limited grasp of purpose.	Some relevant facts are identified, but the overall picture is unclear and lacks development.	The plot lacks coherence and narrates events indiscriminately.
Band 7	0	W1: Content is rarely relevant and there is little material. W2: The structure is disorderly.	Individual ideas are not properly communicated and the effect is one of incoherence.	The plot is hard to follow and is only partially relevant.

Page 8	Mark Scheme	Syllabus	Paper
	Cambridge IGCSE – October/November 2016	0500	31

Table B, Composition: Style and accuracy

Band 1	11–12	Writing is consistent, stylistically fluent, linguistically strong and almost always accurate; has sense of audience. W3: Consistently wide range of appropriate vocabulary. W4: Subtle and effective sense of audience; appropriate use of varied sentence structures. W5: Spelling, punctuation and grammar almost always accurate.
Band 2	9–10	Writing is mostly fluent, sometimes linguistically effective and generally accurate; may have some sense of audience. W3: Obvious attempt to use range of vocabulary to interest the reader. W4: Partial or inferred sense of audience, with appropriate sentence structures. W5: Spelling, punctuation and grammar mainly accurate.
Band 3	7–8	Writing is clear, competent, if plain in vocabulary and grammatical structures; errors minor, but frequent. W3: Occasional precision and/or interest in choice of words. W4: Accurate if repetitive sentence structures W5: Minor but frequent errors of spelling, punctuation and grammar.
Band 4	5–6	Writing is clear and accurate in places, and uses limited vocabulary and grammatical structures; errors occasionally serious. W3: Plain but mostly correct choice of words. W4: Correct use of simple sentence structures; some errors of sentence separation. W5: Frequent errors of spelling, punctuation and grammar.
Band 5	3–4	Writing is simple in vocabulary and grammar; overall meaning can be followed, but errors are distracting and sometimes impair communication. W3: Words may sometimes communicate meaning satisfactorily. W4: Frequent weakness in sentence structures. W5: Errors of spelling, punctuation and grammar impair communication.
Band 6	1–2	Writing is weak in vocabulary and grammar; persistent errors impede communication. W3: Insufficient language to carry intended meaning. W4: Faulty and/or rambling sentence structures. W5: Persistent errors of spelling, punctuation and grammar impede communication.
Band 7	0	Writing is impossible to follow. Language proficiency is lacking; incorrect sentences; multiple errors of spelling, punctuation and grammar.